

Overseas Travel Policy

OBJECTIVE

The purpose of this policy is to provide the rules and procedures governing employees in their travel and business expense activities for Apar. Apar seeks to provide employees with efficient service, comfort and convenience at an economical cost while establishing adequate controls and compliance with travel expense regulations.

All travelers travelling on company business must abide by the overriding principles that;

- Travel arranged and executed must pertain to the legitimate business of the Company or Company's Clients
- All travel requests must be raised 7-10 days in advance and will only be executed by the authorized managers within the company
- Travelers must exercise the best judgment and the highest ethical standards of conduct in all Company business.
- All travelers must submit a Business Travel Report as per the Business Travel Report policy within 3 days of returning from travel excluding weekends and public holidays.

The Company considers violation of any provision in this Policy as misconduct and may result in an employee disciplinary action or rejection of reimbursement claim.

Any questions regarding this Policy should be directed to your local HR manager.

SCOPE

This Policy will include all details (Transport, Accommodation, Allowance etc.) pertaining to an employee's travel for business purposes internationally.

ELIGIBILITY

The policy is applicable to all Overseas Travel to countries where Apar Technologies and / or its customers have operations.

BILLABLE PROJECT TRAVEL

Billable Travel is defined as employee travel to client sites where billable work will be performed and the client is paying for travel expenses.

All travel requests should be accompanied by the client manager's approval. The travel expenses will in most cases be governed by the client's travel policies. There could be cases where the client agrees to reimburse expenses as per Apar's travel policy. Travelers are required to submit copies of all supporting documents for onward submission to the client.

NON BILLABLE/ BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT TRAVEL

Non-Billable / Business Development Travel includes (but is not limited to) the following:

- Project based travel to/from the client site where the client is not paying for expenses.
- Prospective client visits
- Interviews with candidates
- Inter-office travel
- Travel to conferences
- Training, etc.

VISAS

- When traveling across international borders, a Visa may be required. Employees are not permitted to travel internationally for work without the appropriate documentation.
- If you need a Travel Visa or are unaware of a Visa requirement, please contact the travel desk for assistance.

INTERNATIONAL TRAVELLER'S INSURANCE

- Any employee traveling to any country should carry Overseas Medical Insurance Policy with the help of Travel desk, cost of which will be borne by the Company.

TRAVEL PURCHASE GUIDELINES

- **TRAINFARE:** This will include any travel required by train for business purposes
 - All bookings to be made through the official travel agent / travel desk. All reservations to be made in not higher than Second AC.
- **AIR FARE:** This will include any travel required (international) by air for business purposes
 - All bookings to be made through the travel desk only.
 - In exceptional circumstances, if an employee books their own air ticket, prior approval must be obtained from the Head of HR or CEO. It is the individual's responsibility to purchase an economic ticket.
 - In situations where a flight request is received after 6 pm on Friday or after working hours for travel over the weekend or the following public holiday, the employee will be responsible for managing their own booking, with prior cost approval from the Head of HR or CEO.
 - All travel bookings to be made in Economy class and in the most cost-effective airline.
 - Travelers may elect to use upgrades from a personal frequent flyer program; however, upgrades cannot be obtained if there is additional cost to the Company.
 - Employees are free to participate in frequent flyer/loyalty programs however; it is against company policy to select suppliers to achieve personal benefits when less expensive alternatives are available.
 - All bookings to be approved by Head HR.
 - If an employee requests a flight booking different (different travel date, airline etc) from the cheapest option proposed by the travel desk, in such case the differential amount shall be paid by the employee.
- **TIMELINE:**
 - **Urgent Requests (travel within 1 week):**
Tickets will be issued on the same day, provided the requester confirms travel details, the approver responds on time, and the confirmation is received during working hours. Otherwise it will be carry forwarded to next working day.

- **Non-Urgent Requests (travel minimum 2 weeks' notice):**
Tickets will be issued within 2 working days, assuming the requester confirms travel details and the approver responds promptly during working hours.

DAILY ALLOWANCE

These are categorized into four components as given below.

i. GROUND TRANSPORT s CONVEYANCE:

- This will include airport transfers and daily travel
- The conveyance expenses would be reimbursed subject to actuals for the most cost-effective mode of travel (tube / bus / shared cab / cab) and where cost and convenience justify the expense. This would be based on the statement of the places visited for official work by the employee.
- Automobiles should be rented only when public transportation and taxis are impractical. On projects with multiple employees, it is cost prohibitive and environmentally irresponsible to provide one car per employee. Employees are expected to try to coordinate travel schedules to enable sharing rental cars. It is reasonable for 2- 3 employees to share one cab.
- Any Toll charges can be claimed based on actuals. All claims must be supported by receipts.

ii. LODGING: The hotel expense is inclusive of taxes and is subject to actuals.

- Original bills need to be submitted during expense claim.
- Only hotels producing itemized bills including tariff, taxes and/or other service charges shall be considered as valid bills.
- The hotel will be within a 10km radius of the workplace.
- Apar will pre-pay for Room, Tax. All incidentals and room service charges are the Traveler's responsibility. If an employee extends their stay for personal or non-business reasons, the additional costs will be borne by the employee. Hotel accommodation is arranged for single occupancy only; any charges for a spouse or additional guest will be the employee's responsibility.
- Below options are available to Apar Employees, in order of preference.
 1. Accommodation as suggested by the client, if billable
 2. Apar Guest House if available
 3. Apar preferred Budget Hotel

iii. PHONE REIMBURSEMENTS:

- Original bills need to be submitted to claim for phone call reimbursements for official call only, which would be subject to approvals
- Apar would encourage its employees to use WhatsApp/ Skype/MS Teams wherever possible.

iv. PER-DIEM:

- In case Client's policy is available, it will prevail. In case the client's policy is not available, Apar's Travel Policy will be considered.
- The per-diem will be given as per below;
- Per diem includes 2 meals (As breakfast is usually covered in the hotel)
- Travel to office is claimed on actuals
- Laundry is available in a block of every 5 days or more of stay at a reasonable cost.

International Travel	Amount
India	INR 1500
Singapore	SGD 50
Malaysia	RM 70
Thailand	THB 850
USA	USD 50
Europe	Euro 45
UK	GBP 40
UAE	AED 75
Saudi Arabia	SAR 75

ITENIRARY CHANGE/ CANCELLATION REQUEST

- Changes often incur penalties and fare increases. All itinerary change requests must be approved by the client and/or Head HR for non-billable travel.
- It is the traveler's responsibility to obtain this approval before submitting the change request to the original itinerary.
- For changes to your itinerary, please indicate the new dates and preferred flight times.
- For flight changes, your revised itinerary should be on the same airline where possible.

LEAVE WHILE ON TOUR

- Employees shall not be entitled to any leave during the tour except in the case of medical exigencies, which will require certificate from registered medical practitioner.
- If the employee still intends to take leave on occasions other than medical exigencies, s/he shall not be paid any per-diem for the leave period. Employees should declare such leaves diligently while raising the expense claim failing which it shall be deemed as violation of Apar's code of conduct.
- Compensatory off cannot be taken while on tour/client side, you can accumulate such comp offs and take them when you come back your country of origin.

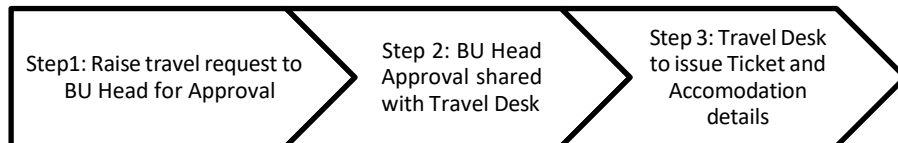
BUSINESS MEALS/ENTERTAINMENT

- Appropriate and reasonable business entertainment expenses are reimbursable only with the advance approval of the Business Unit Head. These are classified as entertainment expenses only if occurred when a vendor or customer is present.

POINTS TO BE NOTED

- Travel desk shall organize the most cost-effective ticket and / or the shortest possible route and no direct bookings are to be given to the travel agent by the employee.
- Employees going onsite on Business Visa will not be entitled to take their families along with them and no reimbursement for the air tickets will be made to them in this regard, unless approved by the Head HR / CEO.
- For the period of the tour, apart from the allowances prescribed in this policy, employee shall be paid salary, in their base location as applicable.
- All employees shall follow the tax guidelines as per local applicable tax laws.
- All appropriate local regulations in the host country shall apply to all employees travelling.
- All employees based in India shall follow the RBI guidelines related to foreign exchange while on overseas travel. (You may refer this link: <http://www.rbi.org.in/scripts/FAQView.aspx?Id=53>)

Process: All travel requests must be submitted by completing the Travel Request Checklist form.



TRAVEL CHECKLIST
REQUEST FORM.xlsx

Travel Desk Details:

Name	Particulars	Details
Haslina Hamzah	haslina.hamzah@apar.com	Primary POC for all travel bookings and visa
Admin Manager	Sanjeev.kumar@apar.com	Escalation 1 POC
Somya Shukla	Somya.shukla@apar.com	Escalation 2 POC
Sanyukta Vohra	sanyukta.vohra@apar.com	Escalation 3 POC

